ZOYA'S ENGLISH — STUDY MODULE

500 Idioms & Phrases

Rebuilt from the original source — interactive web edition plus print-ready A4.

Source: 500 Idioms & Phrases.pdf 11379 words ~64 min read

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500 IDIOMS & PHRASES

WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 1 (1-25) |

A blessing in disguise - Something good that seems bad at first. - Losing that job was a blessing in disguise.

A piece of cake — Very easy. — The test was a piece of cake.

A shot in the dark — A risky attempt with little chance of success. — Applying for the job was a shot in the dark.

Actions speak louder than words — What you do is more important than what you say. — Actions speak louder than words.

Against the clock — In a race against time. — We have to finish this work against the clock. All ears — Listening very attentively. — I’m all ears; please tell me everything. All in the same boat — In the same difficult situation. — We are all in the same boat.

At the end of the day — Ultimately; in the final analysis. — At the end of the day, honesty is the best policy.

Beat around the bush — Avoid the main topic. — Stop beating around the bush and tell me the truth.

Better late than never — It’s good to do something even if it’s delayed. — She started studying; better late than never.

Bite the bullet — Face a difficult situation bravely. — I had to bite the bullet and apologize. Break the ice — To initiate conversation in an awkward situation. — He told a joke to break the ice.

Burn the midnight oil — To work late into the night. — She had to burn the midnight oil to finish the project.

Call it a day — To stop working on something. — It’s getting late, let’s call it a day. Cost an arm and a leg — Very expensive. — This gadget cost me an arm and a leg.

Cut corners — To do something in the easiest or cheapest way, often poorly. — Don’t cut corners, or the work will suffer.

Don’t put all your eggs in one basket — Don’t risk everything on one thing. — Invest in different areas; don’t put all your eggs in one basket.

Every cloud has a silver lining — Every bad situation has a positive side. — He lost his job, but every cloud has a silver lining.

Face the music — To accept the consequences of your actions. — He cheated in the exam and had to face the music.

Hit the nail on the head — To say exactly the right thing. — You hit the nail on the head with your explanation.

In a nutshell — In summary; in a few words. — In a nutshell, the meeting was very productive. In hot water — In trouble. — He is in hot water for missing the deadline.

Let the cat out of the bag — To reveal a secret. — She let the cat out of the bag about the surprise party.

Once in a blue moon — Very rarely. — I visit my hometown once in a blue moon.

Pull someone’s leg — To joke with someone. — He is just pulling your leg; don’t take it seriously.

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Page 2 (26-50) |

Put all your money on something — To risk everything on a single venture. — He put all his money on that start-up.

See eye to eye — To agree with someone. — We don’t always see eye to eye, but we respect each other.

Spill the beans — To reveal a secret. — I wasn’t going to tell anyone, but he spilled the beans.

The ball is in your court — It’s your turn to take action. — I’ve done my part; the ball is in your court.

The early bird catches the worm — Success comes to those who act early. — The early bird catches the worm.

The last straw — The final problem in a series of problems. — His rudeness was the last straw. Under the weather — Feeling slightly ill. — I’m a little under the weather today.

A dime a dozen — Very common and therefore of little value. - Complaints from customers are a dime a dozen.

A rolling stone gathers no moss — A person who moves around a lot has no stable home or job. — He keeps changing jobs; a rolling stone gathers no moss.

Add fuel to the fire — To make a bad situation worse. — Their argument only added fuel to the fire.

Bark up the wrong tree — To blame or criticize the wrong person. — You’re barking up the wrong tree; I didn’t do it.

Better safe than sorry — It’s better to be careful than to take risks. — | always double-check; better safe than sorry.

Don’t judge a book by its cover — Don’t judge someone or something by appearance. — He looked quiet, but don’t judge a book by its cover.

Don’t count your chickens before they hatch — Don’t expect success too early. — Let’s wait for the results; don’t count your chickens before they hatch.

Down to earth — Practical and realistic. - She’s very down to earth despite her success. Get out of hand — To become uncontrolled. — The situation got out of hand quickly.

Give someone the benefit of the doubt — To trust someone despite uncertainty. — I will give him the benefit of the doubt this time.

Go the extra mile — To make extra effort. - She always goes the extra mile to help others. Hit the books — To study very hard. — I need to hit the books for the exam.

Keep an eye on — To watch or monitor something. — Please keep an eye on the kids.

Let sleeping dogs lie — To avoid bringing up a topic that may cause trouble. — It’s best to let sleeping dogs lie.

Make ends meet — To have just enough money for basic needs. — It’s hard to make ends meet

these days.

Miss the boat — To miss an opportunity. — I missed the boat when I didn’t apply on time.
On the same page — To agree and understand the same thing. — Let’s make sure we are on the same page.

Out of the blue — Suddenly and unexpectedly. — He called me out of the blue after years.

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 3 (51-75)

Piece of mind — A state of being calm and free from worry. — After the vacation, I finally got some piece of mind.

Play it by ear — To deal with a situation in a flexible way. —- We don’t have a plan; let’s play it by ear.

Put your foot down — To establish authority; to insist on something. — You need to put your foot down with your children.

Read between the lines — To understand the hidden meaning. — You should read between the lines of his email.

Right under someone’s nose — In a place that is very obvious. — The keys were right under my nose the whole time.

Safe and sound — In a state of safety; without harm. — He returned home safe and sound.

See the light — To understand or suddenly realize something. — After a long talk, he finally saw the light.

Speak of the devil — Used when the person you are talking about appears. — Speak of the devil, and he shows up!

Stand on your own two feet — To be independent; to support yourself. — After college, she started to stand on her own two feet.

Start from scratch — To begin again from the beginning. — He lost all his data and had to start from scratch.

Step up to the plate — To accept a challenge or take responsibility. — It’s time for you to step up to the plate.

Take a back seat — To take a less active role; to allow others to lead. — He decided to take a back seat in the project.

Take it with a grain of salt — To consider something with doubt. — Don’t believe everything you hear; take it with a grain of salt.

The calm before the storm — A quiet period before a difficult time. — There was a calm before the storm.

The pen is mightier than the sword — Words and writing are more powerful than violence. — The pen is mightier than the sword.

There’s no place like home — Home is the best place to be. — After traveling so much, I realized there’s no place like home.

Think outside the box — To be creative and think differently. — We need to think outside the box to solve this problem.

Throw in the towel — To give up; to admit defeat. — He threw in the towel after many failed attempts.

Time flies — Time passes quickly. — I can’t believe how time flies!

Under the table — In a secret or illegal way. — They settled the deal under the table.

Up in the air — Not yet decided. — Our plans for the trip are still up in the air.

Walk the talk — To do what you say you will do. — Don’t just promise; walk the talk.

Watch your step — To be careful. — The floor is wet, so watch your step.

When in Rome, do as the Romans do — To adapt to the customs of a place. - When in Rome, do as the Romans do.

You can’t judge a book by its cover — Don’t judge by appearance. — You can’t judge a book by its cover.

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Page 4 (76-100)

A blessing in disguise — Something that seems bad but turns out to be good. — Losing that job was a blessing in disguise; | found a better opportunity.

A drop in the ocean — A very small amount compared to what is needed. — His donation is just a drop in the ocean compared to the total cost.

A picture is worth a thousand words — A visual can explain something better than words. — The chart makes it clear; a picture is worth a thousand words.

Back to the drawing board — To start over and try a new approach. — The plan didn’t work, so it’s back to the drawing board.

Beat a dead horse — To do something that is useless because it has already failed. — There’s no point in arguing; that’s beating a dead horse.

Bite off more than you can chew — To take on more responsibility than you can handle. — I bit off more than I could chew with three projects at once.

Call the shots — To be in control; to make decisions. — In this team, she calls the shots.

Costs an arm and a leg — Very expensive. — That designer bag costs an arm and a leg!

Cross that bridge when you come to it — Deal with a problem when it happens, not before. — Don’t worry now; we’ll cross that bridge when we come to it.

Dance around the issue — Avoid talking about the real problem. — Stop dancing around the issue and tell me what’s wrong.

Don’t bite the hand that feeds you — Don’t harm those who help you. — Be respectful to your employer; don’t bite the hand that feeds you.

Earn your keep — To do your job or work for the money you receive. — You're here to earn your keep, so get to work.

Every dog has its day — Everyone will have a chance to succeed someday. — He’s going through a tough time, but every dog has its day.

Eye for an eye, tooth for a tooth — Revenge in equal measure. — That policy is eye for an eye, tooth for a tooth.

Feather in your cap — An achievement to be proud of. — Winning the award was a feather in his cap.

Get back on your feet — To recover from a difficult situation. — It took time, but she got back on her feet.

Get cold feet — To suddenly become nervous and lose confidence. — He got cold feet before the final match.

Give it your best shot — To try your best. — You may not win, but give it your best shot.

Go with the flow — To accept things as they happen and not try to control them. — Sometimes you just have to go with the flow.

Hit below the belt — To say or do something unfair or cruel. - His comment about her family was a low blow; he hit below the belt.

Hold your horses — To wait; to be patient. — Hold your horses! Your turn will come.

Keep your chin up — To stay cheerful and not lose hope. — Things will get better; keep your chin up.

Kill two birds with one stone — To achieve two things at the same time. — By studying abroad, he improved his English and gained experience; he killed two birds with one stone.

Let bygones be bygones — To forgive past mistakes and move on. — We argued before, but let bygones be bygones.

Light at the end of the tunnel — A sign of hope in a difficult situation. — After months of struggle, there’s finally light at the end of the tunnel.

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| Page 5 (101-125)

)1. Mad as a hatter — Extremely crazy. — He was mad as a hatter when he heard the news.

)2. Make a long story short — To give only the main details. — Make a long story short, we missed the bus.

)3. Make a mountain out of a molehill — To make a big deal out of something small. — It’s just

a small mistake; don’t make a mountain out of a molehill. | 104. Miss the point — To fail to understand the main idea. — You completely missed the point of

my argument.

)5. Move heaven and earth — To make every possible effort. — I will move heaven and earth to help you.

)6. No pain, no gain — You have to work hard to achieve success. — There’s no pain, no gain in life.

)7. Not my cup of tea — Not something I like. — Horror movies are not my cup of tea.

)8. Once bitten, twice shy — After being hurt, you become more careful. — He’s once bitten, twice shy when it comes to investments.

)9. On cloud nine — Extremely happy. — She was on cloud nine after getting the job.

.0. On the ball — To be alert and quick to act. — You need to be on the ball to handle this project.

.1. Out of sight, out of mind — When you don’t see someone, you stop thinking about them. — I haven’t seen him in years, out of sight, out of mind.

.2. Practice makes perfect — The more you practice, the better you become. — Practice makes perfect; keep trying.

.3. Press the panic button — To react in a way that shows you are very worried. — There’s no need to press the panic button; everything is fine.

.4. Piece by piece — Gradually and step by step. — We rebuilt the old house piece by piece.

.5. Pull yourself together — To calm down and get control of your emotions. — It’s not a big deal; pull yourself together.

.6. Put all cards on the table — To be completely honest and open. — Let’s put all cards on the table and discuss the truth.

.7. Put the cart before the horse — To do things in the wrong order. — You’re putting the cart before the horse; we need a plan first.

.8. Rain cats and dogs — To rain very heavily. — It rained cats and dogs all day yesterday.

.9. See eye to eye — To agree with someone. — We don’t always see eye to eye, but we respect each other. 120. See through — To understand someone’s true intentions. — I can see through his lies.

!0. Set in stone — Something that is decided and cannot be changed. — The meeting time is set in stone. 122. Shape up or ship out — To improve your behavior or leave. — Shape up or ship out; these are the rules. 123. The calm before the storm — A quiet period before a difficult time. — The calm before the storm

always makes me nervous. 124. The elephant in the room — A big problem that everyone ignores. — His illness was the elephant in the room. | 125. The grass is always greener on the other side — People think others have a better life. — The grass is always greener on the other side.

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Page 6 (126-150)

The lion’s share — The largest part. - He did most of the work and got the lion’s share of the credit.

The tip of the iceberg — Only a small part of a much larger problem. — What you see is just the tip of the iceberg.

There’s no smoke without fire — Where there’s some truth in a rumor. — There’s no smoke without fire; there must be some reason.

This is easier said than done — Something is more difficult to do than to say. — It’s easy to give advice, but this is easier said than done.

Throw caution to the wind — To take a risk and do something without worrying. — He threw caution to the wind and started his own business.

Tighten your belt — To spend less money; to be more careful. — We need to tighten our belts

this month.

Time and tide wait for no man — Time moves on and does not stop for anyone. — Time and tide wait for no man; we must act now.

To each his own — Everyone has their own opinion or choice. — She likes coffee, I like tea; to each his own.

Too many cooks spoil the broth — Too many people doing a task can cause problems. — Everyone gave advice, and too many cooks spoiled the broth.

Turn a blind eye — To deliberately ignore something. — The teacher turned a blind eye to the students’ talking.

Two sides of the same coin — Two things that are similar and connected. — Freedom and responsibility are two sides of the same coin.

Under the knife — To be in surgery. — He is under the knife right now.

Under your nose — Very close to you. — The book was under your nose the whole time!

Up in arms — Very angry about something. — People were up in arms about the new rule.

Use your head — To think and be sensible. — Use your head and you’ll find a solution.

Walk on eggshells — To be very careful not to upset someone. — I have to walk on eggshells around my boss.

What goes around comes around — The good or bad things you do will happen to you too. — Be kind, because what goes around comes around.

When push comes to shove — When a difficult situation requires a decision or action. — When push came to shove, he stood by his friend.

Wild goose chase — A long and foolish search for something that cannot be found. — It was a wild goose chase; the information didn’t exist.

Win some, lose some — In any activity, you cannot succeed all the time. — You can’t win every match; win some, lose some.

With flying colors — Very successfully. — She passed the exam with flying colors.

Worth your salt — Good at your job; deserving of your pay. — He’s young, but he’s worth his salt. You can’t have your cake and eat it too — You can’t enjoy two good things that are impossible together. — You can’t skip study and expect good marks; you can’t have your cake and eat it too. Your guess is as good as mine — I have no idea. — Where did he go? Your guess is as good as mine.

Zip your lip — To be quiet. — Zip your lip and listen to what the teacher is saying.

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A bad apple — A person who behaves badly and influences others. — He is a bad apple in the group.

Actions speak louder than words — What you do is more important than what you say. — He helps others; actions speak louder than words.

Add insult to injury — To make a bad situation worse. — When he failed the test and lost his wallet, it was adding insult to injury.

Against the clock — In a race against time. — We had to finish the project against the clock. All ears — Listening very attentively. — Tell me more; I’m all ears.

All in good time — Everything will happen when it should. — You’ll understand when you're older; all in good time.

All that glitters is not gold — Not everything that looks good is valuable. — His offer looks great, but all that glitters is not gold.

Bite off more than you can chew — To take more responsibility than you can handle, — He bit off more than he could chew and got stressed.

Break a leg — Good luck! (said to someone before a performance) — You have a big match today — break a leg!

Break the ice — To start a conversation in a social situation. — He told a joke to break the ice. Burn the midnight oil — To work late into the night. — She had to burn the midnight oil to finish her assignment.

Cost an arm and a leg — Very expensive. — That phone costs an arm and a leg!

Don’t cry over spilled milk — Don’t worry about things that cannot be changed. — It’s over now; don’t cry over spilled milk.

Don’t put all your eggs in one basket — Don’t risk everything on one plan. — It’s smart not to put all your eggs in one basket.

Down in the dumps — Feeling sad or depressed. — I felt down in the dumps after the results. Every cloud has a silver lining — There is something good in every bad situation. — He lost his job, but every cloud has a silver lining.

Face the music — To accept the punishment for your actions. — You broke the rules, now face the music.

Get a taste of your own medicine — To experience the same bad treatment you gave others. — He was rude to everyone; now he’s getting a taste of his own medicine.

Get the ball rolling — To start something. — Let’s get the ball rolling on this project.

Get wind of something — To hear about something by chance. — I got wind of the news yesterday. Go back to the drawing board — To start over after a failure. - The plan didn’t work, so we have to go back to the drawing board.

Go down the wrong path — To start doing something that is not right. - He was a good student but went down the wrong path.

Hit the nail on the head — To say or do exactly the right thing. — You hit the nail on the head with your suggestion.

In black and white — In writing; clearly and officially. - Get the agreement in black and white. In hot water — In trouble. — He’s in hot water for breaking the rules.

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Page 8 (176-200)

In the same boat — In a similar situation. — We are all in the same boat; everyone is facing

problems. Jump the gun — To do something too early. — You jumped the gun by telling him the surprise.

Keep an eye on — To watch or monitor something. — Please keep an eye on the kids while I'm out.

Keep your fingers crossed — To hope for the best. — I have an interview tomorrow; keep your fingers crossed for me.

Kill two birds with one stone — To accomplish two things with one action. — I finished my homework while listening to music; I killed two birds with one stone.

Let the cat out of the bag — To reveal a secret. — Who let the cat out of the bag about the party?

Let sleeping dogs lie — To avoid disturbing a situation that is not causing problems. — It’s better to let sleeping dogs lie and not bring up the old issue.

Like two peas in a pod — Very similar. — Those twins are like two peas in a pod. Live and let live — To allow others to live their own lives. — We should live and let live.

Long time no see — Used when you haven’t seen someone for a long time. — Long time no see! How have you been?

Lose track of time — To forget about time while doing something. — I lose track of time when I’m reading a good book.

Make a bee line — To go somewhere as quickly as possible. — As soon as the class ended, I made a bee line for home.

Make ends meet — To have just enough money to pay for necessities. — It’s not easy to make ends meet these days.

Make up your mind — To decide something. — Please make up your mind soon.

Many hands make light work — A task is easier when many people help. — We finished early because many hands make light work.

Miss the boat — To miss an opportunity. — You snoozed and missed the boat; the offer is over now. Neck and neck — Very close in competition. — The two teams are neck and neck in the race.

Neither here nor there — Not important; not related to the topic. — That comment is neither here nor there in our discussion.

No news is good news — If you don’t hear anything bad, everything is probably fine. — He hasn’t called, but no news is good news.

Not lift a finger — To do no work or help. — He sat on the sofa all day and didn’t lift a finger to help.

Once in a blue moon — Very rarely. — We get to meet once in a blue moon.

Out of the blue — Suddenly; unexpectedly. — He called me out of the blue after many years. Out of the question — Impossible; not allowed. — Going out tonight is out of the question. Over the moon — Extremely happy. — I was over the moon when I got the job!

Pay through the nose — To pay a lot of money for something. — We paid through the nose for those concert tickets.

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Page 9 (201—225)

Piece of cake — Very easy. — The test was a piece of cake.

Play by ear — To decide what to do as a situation develops. — We didn’t have a plan, so we played it by ear.

Pull the wool over someone’s eyes — To deceive someone. — He tried to pull the wool over

our eyes, but we knew the truth.

Put a sock in it — To be quiet. — Put a sock in it! You’re talking too much.

Put your foot down — To be firm and refuse to allow something. — I had to put my foot down and say no.

Read between the lines — To understand the hidden meaning. — Read between the lines; he’s not interested.

Ring a bell — To sound familiar. — Your name rings a bell, but I can’t place where I know you from.

See eye to eye — To agree with someone. — We don’t always see eye to eye, but we respect each other. Speak of the devil — Used when the person you're talking about appears. — Speak of the devil, here he comes!

Spill the beans — To reveal a secret. — Don’t spill the beans about the surprise party.

Still waters run deep — Quiet people often have strong minds or feelings. — He is very quiet,

but still waters run deep.

Take it or leave it — An offer with no room for negotiation. — This is my final offer, take it or leave it.

Take the bull by the horns — To deal with a difficult situation bravely. — I decided to take the bull by the horns and talk to my boss.

Take with a grain of salt — To accept with doubt. — Take his advice with a grain of salt.

That’s the last straw — The final problem in a series of problems. — That was the last straw; I quit my job. The early bird catches the worm — Success comes to those who act early. — He always arrives early; the early bird catches the worm.

The grass is always greener on the other side — People think others have a better life. — The grass is always greener on the other side.

The ball is in your court — It’s your decision or responsibility now. — I’ve done my part; the ball is in your court.

The benefit of the doubt — Giving someone a chance to be honest. — I'll give him the benefit of the doubt.

The calm before the storm — A quiet time before something bad happens. — The calm before the storm made everyone nervous.

The elephant in the room — A big problem that people avoid talking about. — We can’t solve this until we talk about the elephant in the room.

The long and short of it — The main point or the basics. — The long and short of it is that we need more time. The salt of the earth — A very good and honest person. — My grandfather was the salt of the earth. Turn over a new leaf — To start a new life and change bad habits. — After the new year, I tumed over a new leaf.

Two wrongs don’t make a right — Doing wrong in return doesn’t solve the problem. — We should talk, not fight; two wrongs don’t make a right.

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Page 10 (226-250)

Under the weather — Feeling sick. — I’m a little under the weather today.

Up in the air — Not yet decided. — The plan is still up in the air.

Vanish into thin air — To disappear completely. — The magician made the coin vanish into thin air.

Watch your back — To be careful; beware of danger. — He smiled at me, but I’m still watching my back.

Weigh the pros and cons — To consider both good and bad sides. — Before making a decision, weigh the pros and cons.

Well at the end that well — Used to say that a bad situation turned out well. — We got lost, but it was well at the end that well.

What goes up must come down — Success won’t last forever. — Remember, what goes up must come down.

When in Rome, do as the Romans do — Follow local customs when you are in a new place. — When in Rome, do as the Romans do.

Where there’s a will, there’s a way — Determination helps achieve goals. — Where there’s a will, there’s a way to succeed.

Whoever laughs last laughs best — The person who wins in the end is the real winner. — He laughed at me first, but whoever laughs last laughs best.

Wild horses couldn’t drag me away — Used to say you really enjoy being somewhere. — I love this place; wild horses couldn’t drag me away.

You can lead a horse to water, but you can’t make it drink — You can’t force someone to do something. — I advised him many times, but you can lead a horse to water, but you can’t make it drink.

You can’t judge a book by its cover — Don’t judge someone by their appearance. — He looks serious, but you can’t judge a book by its cover.

You can’t have it both ways — You must choose between two options. — You can’t have it both ways; either you stay late or leave early.

You can’t teach an old dog new tricks — It’s hard to change someone’s old habits. — He’s stubborn; you can’t teach an old dog new tricks.

A blessing in disguise — Something good that seems bad at first. - Losing that job was a blessing in disguise.

A dime a dozen — Very common or of little value. — These souvenirs are a dime a dozen. A friend in need is a friend indeed — True friends help in difficult times. — He helped me during my illness; a friend in need is a friend indeed.

A picture is worth a thousand words — Pictures can explain things better than words. — The chart says it all; a picture is worth a thousand words.

Actions speak louder than words — Actions are more important than what you say. — Don’t just promise; actions speak louder than words.

Add fuel to the fire — To make a bad situation worse. — His rude comment only added fuel to the fire.

All bark and no bite — Someone who threatens but doesn’t act. — He talks a lot, but he’s all bark and no bite.

All that glitters is not gold — Not everything that looks good is valuable. - Don’t be fooled; all that glitters is not gold.

An arm and a leg — Very expensive. — That watch costs an arm and a leg.

As blind as a bat — Unable to see very well. — I’m as blind as a bat without my glasses.

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 11 (251-275)

Back to the drawing board — To start over after a failure. - The plan didn’t work, so we went back to the drawing board.

Beat around the bush — To avoid the main topic. — Stop beating around the bush and tell me the truth.

Better late than never — It’s good to do something even if it’s late. — You apologized today; better late than never.

Between a rock and a hard place — In a difficult situation with no good choices. — He is between a rock and a hard place about which job to take.

Bite the bullet — To face a painful or difficult situation bravely. — I didn’t want to go to the dentist, but I bit the bullet.

Break the news — To tell someone bad or surprising news. — It’s never easy to break the news to a friend.

Bring home the bacon — To earn money to support your family. — He works hard every day to bring home the bacon.

Burn bridges — To do something that makes it impossible to have a good relationship again. — After his rude comment, he burned bridges with his boss.

Call it a day — To stop working or doing something for the day. — It’s getting late; let’s call it a day.

Catch someone red-handed — To catch someone doing something wrong. — The teacher caught him red-handed cheating in the exam.

Cost an arm and a leg — Very expensive. — That designer bag costs an arm and a leg! Cut to the chase — To get to the point quickly. — I don’t have much time, so cut to the chase. Don’t count your chickens before they hatch — Don’t expect success before it happens. — Let’s wait for the result; don’t count your chickens before they hatch.

Don’t put all your eggs in one basket — Don’t risk everything on one plan or idea. — He started another business; he didn’t put all his eggs in one basket.

Down to earth — Practical and realistic. — She is a famous actor but still very down to earth. Drive someone up the wall — To annoy someone very much. — His constant questions are driving me up the wall!

Every dog has its day — Everyone will have a chance to succeed. — Don’t worry; every dog has its day.

Face the music — To accept the punishment for your mistakes. — You broke the rules; now you have to face the music.

Figure it out — To understand or solve something. — I need some time to figure this out. Go the extra mile — To do more than what is expected. — She always goes the extra mile for her students.

Go with the flow — To accept things as they happen and not try to control everything. — Sometimes, it’s better to go with the flow.

Have a soft spot for someone — To be kind and caring toward someone. — I have a soft spot for animals.

Hit the books — To study very hard. — I have to hit the books to pass this exam.

Hold your horses — To wait and be patient. — Hold your horses! I will explain everything. In a nutshell — In short; in a few words. — In a nutshell, the meeting was a success.

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 12 (276-300)

In black and white — In writing; clearly and officially. — Please get our agreement in black and white.

In the same boat — In the same difficult situation. — We are all in the same boat during this crisis.

In the thick of it — In the middle of a difficult situation. - The manager is in the thick of it right now.

In the wrong place at the wrong time — To be present when something bad happens. — I was in the wrong place at the wrong time.

It takes two to tango — Both people are responsible for a situation. — Don’t blame him; it takes two to tango.

Keep your chin up — To stay positive and keep trying. — You failed the test, but keep your chin up; you can do better next time.

Keep your eye on the ball — To stay focused on what you are doing. — Don’t get distracted; keep your eye on the ball.

Keep your shirt on — To calm down; don’t panic. — Keep your shirt on! Everything will be fine. Kick the bucket — To die. - My grandfather passed away; he kicked the bucket last night.

Let bygones be bygones — To forgive and forget the past. — We argued a lot, but let bygones be bygones.

Let the sleeping dogs lie — To avoid causing problems by bringing up old issues. — It’s better to let the sleeping dogs lie.

Like a fish out of water — To feel uncomfortable in a situation. — He felt like a fish out of water at the party.

Live from hand to mouth — To have just enough money to survive. — Many people live from hand to mouth.

More than meets the eye — Better or more important than it seems. — She is quiet, but there’s more than meets the eye.

Not my cup of tea — Not something I like. - Horror movies are not my cup of tea.

Once bitten, twice shy — After being hurt once, you are careful next time. — I was cheated before, so once bitten, twice shy. Out of sight, out of mind — When you don’t see someone, you stop thinking about them. — She moved away, and out of sight, out of mind. Out of the woods — Safe from danger or trouble. — We still have challenges, but we're out of the woods. Pay through the nose — To pay a lot of money. — He paid through the nose for that designer watch. Piece of mind — A state of being calm and stress-free. — I just want some peace of mind. Pull yourself together — To calm down

and behave properly. — You have an interview; pull yourself together! Put all your cards on the table — To be honest about your plans or feelings. — Let’s put all our cards on the table. Shoot from the hip — To say or do something without thinking. - He always shoots from the hip. Speak of the devil — Someone appears who was just talked about. — Speak of the devil! Here he comes. Strike while the iron is hot — To act immediately when there is an opportunity. — We got a good offer; let’s strike while the iron is hot.

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 13 (301-325)

Take a back seat — To be less important; to let others lead. — In this project, P'll take a back Take it with a pinch of salt — To not believe something completely. — His story sounds strange; take it with a pinch of salt.

The ball is in your court — It’s your turn to act or decide. — I’ve done my part; now the ball is in your court.

The bottom line — The most important point. — The bottom line is that we need more time.

The calm before the storm — A quiet time before something bad happens. — The calm before the storm made everyone nervous.

The door is always open — You are always welcome. — If you need help, remember the door is always open.

The elephant in the room — A big problem that everyone ignores. — We need to talk about the elephant in the room.

The icing on the cake — Something extra that makes a good thing better. — Getting a bonus was the icing on the cake!

The last but not the least — Used to introduce the final point. — We visited many places; the last but not the least was the museum.

The more, the merrier — More people or things make a situation more enjoyable. — The more friends we have, the merrier!

The proof of the pudding is in the eating — You can only judge something by experiencing it. — The proof of the pudding is in the eating; try it and see.

The writing is on the wall — A sign of something bad that will happen. — The company is losing money; the writing is on the wall.

There is no free lunch — Nothing is given without any cost or effort. — If you want success, remember there is no free lunch.

Time and tide wait for none — Time and opportunities do not wait for anyone. — Don’t waste time; time and tide wait for none.

Under the gun — Under pressure; in a difficult situation. - We have to finish the work under the gun. Until the cows come home — For a very long time. — I waited for him until the cows came home!

Variety is the spice of life — Different things make life more interesting. — I love trying new foods; variety is the spice of life.

When pigs fly — Something that will never happen. — He will clean his room when pigs fly!

Where there’s smoke, there’s fire — If there is a sign of trouble, it is likely tue. — There are rumors, and where there’s smoke, there’s fire.

You can’t have your cake and eat it too — You can’t enjoy two good things that conflict. — You can’t skip practice and expect to win; you can’t have your cake and eat it too.

You can’t make an omelette without breaking a few eggs — To achieve something, small problems are necessary. — Every success comes with challenges; you can’t make an omelette without breaking a few eggs.

Actions speak louder than words — What you do is more important than what you say. — Stop talking and start helping; actions speak louder than words.

A diamond in the rough — A good person or thing that needs polishing. — She is a diamond in the rough; with training, she will shine.

A horse of a different color — Something or someone very different. — This phone is a horse of a different color; I've never seen one like it!

A little bird told me — A way of saying you heard a secret or rumor. — A little bird told me about your surprise party!

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 14 (326-350) |

26. A penny for your thoughts — Asking someone what they are thinking. — You look so quiet; a penny for your thoughts?

27. A shot in the dark — A guess without much knowledge. — It was a shot in the dark, but I think I got it right.

28. As right as rain — In perfect health or working order. — Don't worry about my car; it's running as right as rain.

29. At death's door — Very close to dying. — He was at death's door after the accident.

30. At loose ends — Having nothing to do. — I'm at loose ends this weekend; want to go out?

31. At the drop of a hat — Immediately; without any delay. — He would help anyone at the drop of a hat.

32. Back on track — Doing well again after a problem. — After a hard time, he is finally back on track.

33. Barking up the wrong tree — Pursuing the wrong person or thing. — If you think I took your pen, you're barking up the wrong tree.

34. Beat a dead horse — To do something that is useless because it won't change anything. — We can't change the decision now; let's stop beating a dead horse.

35. Birds of a feather flock together — People with similar interests or qualities stay together. — They are always together; birds of a feather flock together.

36. Bite off more than you can chew — To take on more than you can handle. — He bit off more than he could chew with three jobs.

37. Break a leg — A way to wish someone good luck, especially before a performance. — You have your exam today? Break a leg!

38. Call it a day — To stop working. — We've been working for hours; let's call it a day.

39. | Cut corners — To do something in the easiest or cheapest way, usually not the best way. — Don't cut comers; quality is important.

40. Don't put all your eggs in one basket — Don't risk everything on one plan. — Smart investors don't put all their eggs in one basket.

41. Face the music — To accept the punishment for your actions. — He lied to his parents and now has to face the music.

42. Feeling under the weather — Not feeling well. — I'm feeling a little under the weather today.

43. Get out of hand — To become uncontrolled. —- The party got out of hand after midnight.

44. | Give someone the benefit of the doubt — To trust someone even if you are not sure. — Let's give him the benefit of the doubt this time.

45. | Go back to square one — To start again after a failure. — The project failed, so we have to go back to square one.

46. Go the extra mile — To do more than what is expected. — She always goes the extra mile for her students.

47. Hit the nail on the head — To say or do exactly the right thing. — You hit the nail on the head with your comment.

48. It’s not my cup of tea — Not something I like. —- Rock music is not my cup of tea.

49. Jump the gun — To start something too early. —- Don’t jump the gun; wait for the signal.

50. Keep an eye on — To watch or monitor something. — I will keep an eye on your bag

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 15 (351-375)

51. Keep your fingers crossed — To hope for the best. — I have an interview today; keep your fingers crossed for me.

52. Keep your head above water — To manage to survive in a difficult situation. — It was hard, but we managed to keep our heads above water.

53. Kill two birds with one stone — To do two things at the same time. — I went to the bank and did some shopping; killed two birds with one stone.

54. Laugh up your sleeve — To hide your true feelings and secretly laugh. — He agreed with them, but he was laughing up his sleeve.

55. Let the cat out of the bag — To reveal a secret. — She let the cat out of the bag about the surprise party.

56. Let sleeping dogs lie — To avoid causing problems by not bringing up old issues. — We should let sleeping dogs lie and move on.

57. Like chalk and cheese — Very different from each other. - My two brothers are like chalk and cheese in personality.

58. Living in a fool’s paradise — To believe something that is not true. — He thinks he will win the lottery, living in a fool’s paradise.

59. Look before you leap — To think carefully before you do something. — Always look before you leap into a decision.

60. Lose heart — To become sad or disappointed. — Don’t lose heart; keep trying.

61. Make a long story short — To give only the important details. — I won’t bore you with details; to make a long story short, I got the job.

62. Miss the boat — To miss an opportunity. — I wanted to apply, but missed the boat.

63. Once in a blue moon — Very rarely. — We go on a vacation once in a blue moon.

64. On the same wavelength — To think or feel the same way. — We are on the same wavelength about the issue.

65. Out of the question — Impossible; not acceptable. — It’s out of the question that I will quit now.

66. Out of the blue — Suddenly; without warning. — She called me out of the blue.

67. Play it by ear — To deal with something as it happens. — We don’t have a plan, we'll just play it by ear.

68. Put a sock in it — To tell someone to be quiet. — Put a sock in it and let others speak!

69. Pull someone’s leg — To joke with someone. — Don’t worry, I’m just pulling your leg.

70. Right under your nose — Very close to you, but not noticed. — The answer was right under my nose!

71. See eye to eye — To agree with someone. — We don’t always see eye to eye.

72. Speak of the devil — Used when the person you were talking about appears. — Speak of the devil! Here he comes.

73. Spill the beans — To reveal a secret. — He spilled the beans about the new project.

74. Take it or leave it — To accept something or reject it. — That’s the final offer, take it or leave it.

75. The ball is in your court — It’s your tur to act or decide. — I’ve done my part; now

the ball is in your court. a ‘ — @omiistudies —

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 16 (376-400)

'6. The best of both worlds — To have two good things at the same time. — She has a great job and more free time; the best of both worlds!

'7. The bigger picture — The most important thing to consider. — Don't get worried about small mistakes; look at the bigger picture.

'8. The blind leading the blind — When unqualified people guide others. — It's like the blind leading the blind when he gives advice.

'9. The calm after the storm — A quiet time after a difficult situation. — We enjoyed the calm after the storm.

80. The cream of the crop — The best of a group. — She is the cream of the crop in our class.

81. The early bird catches the worm — Success comes to those who act early. — Wake up early; the early bird catches the worm.

82. The elephant in the room — A big problem that everyone ignores. — We all know the elephant in the room, but no one wants to talk about it.

83. The grass is always greener on the other side — People think others have it better. — The grass is always greener on the other side; be happy with what you have.

84. The last straw — The final problem that causes a reaction. — His rude behavior was the

last straw. 385. The lion's share — The largest part. — He did most of the work, but took the lion's share of the credit.

86. The long and short of it — The main point in brief. — The long and short of it is that

87. The tip of the iceberg — A small part of a much bigger problem. — What we saw is just the tip of the iceberg.

38. There’s no place like home — Home is the best place. — After traveling, I realize there’s no place like home.

39. Through thick and thin — In good times and bad times. — We have been friends through thick and thin.

40. To make matters worse — To make a bad situation even worse. — I missed the bus and to make matters worse, it started raining!

41. To see eye to eye — To agree with someone. — We don’t always see eye to eye on politics.

42. ‘To turn a blind eye — To ignore something wrong. — The teacher can’t turn a blind eye to cheating.

43. Under the same roof — Living in the same house or working in the same place. — It’s not easy to live under the same roof with so many people.

44. When in Rome, do as the Romans do — Adapt to the place or situation. — When in Rome, do as the Romans do.

45. Actions speak louder than words — What you do is more important than what you say. — He didn’t promise; his actions speak louder than words.

46. All that glitters is not gold — Everything that looks good is not valuable. — Don’t trust everything you see; all that glitters is not gold.

47. As easy as pie — Very easy. — The test was as easy as pie!

48. Break the ice — To initiate conversation in an awkward situation. — He told a joke to break the ice. 399, Burn the midnight oil — To work late into the night. — I have to bum the midnight oil to finish the project. 400. Costs an arm and a leg — Very expensive. — That car costs an arm and a leg! — @omiistudies —

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 17 (401-425)

)1. Cross that bridge when we come to it — Deal with a problem when it happens. — Why worry now? We'll cross that bridge when we come to it.

)2. Don’t count your chickens before they hatch — Don’t expect something before it happens. — I know you’re excited, but don’t count your chickens before they hatch.

)3. Don’t have a cow — To stay calm; not to panic. — It’s just a small mistake, don’t have a cow!

)4. Don’t judge a book by its cover — Don’t judge by appearance. — He may look quiet, but don’t judge a book by its cover.

)5. Every cloud has a silver lining — Every problem has something good. — I know you failed, but every cloud has a silver lining.

)6. From the horse’s mouth — Direct information from the person involved. — I heard it from the horse’s mouth, so it must be true.

)7. Get your act together — To organize yourself and start behaving seriously. — You need to get your act together if you want to pass.

)8. Go with the flow — To accept things as they happen. — Life is easier when you go with the flow.

)9. Half a loaf is better than none — It’s better to have something than nothing. — I didn’t get the job I wanted, but half a loaf is better than none.

.0. Hit the books — To study hard. — I have an exam tomorrow, so I need to hit the books.

.1. In black and white — In a clear and definite way; in writing. — Get the agreement in black and white before you start the project.

.2. It takes two to tango — Both people are responsible for a situation. — Don’t blame me alone; it takes two to tango.

.3. Keep an open mind — To be willing to consider new ideas. — Listen to the plan with an open mind before you decide.

.4. __ Let bygones be bygones — To forgive and forget the past. — We had a fight, but let bygones be bygones.

.5. Make ends meet — To have enough money to pay for what you need. — It’s hard to make ends meet with this salary.

.6. Once bitten, twice shy — If you are hurt once, you will be more careful next time. — He was cheated before, so once bitten, twice shy.

.7. Out of sight, out of mind — If you don’t see someone, you forget about them. — We haven’t met for years; out of sight, out of mind.

.8. Piece of cake — Very easy. — The test was a piece of cake!

.9. See the light — To understand something suddenly. — After reading the book, I finally saw the light.

!0. The penny drops — To understand something suddenly. — It took a while, but then the penny dropped.

!1. The window of opportunity — A short time when something good can happen. — You must act fast; this is your window of opportunity.

!2. ‘Two sides of the same coin — Two things that are similar. — Success and failure are two sides of the same coin.

!3. Walk the talk — To do what you say. — He says he cares about the environment and really walks the talk.

!4. What goes around comes around — Good or bad things will happen to you based on your actions. — He hurt many people, but what goes around comes around.

!5. When the going gets tough, the tough get going — Strong people keep trying in difficult times. — Challenges are normal; when the going gets tough, the tough get going. — @omiistudies —

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 18 (426-450)

26. A barking dog never bites — Someone who acts aggressively is usually not dangerous. — He keeps shouting, but a barking dog never bites.

27. Actions louder than words — What you do is more important than what you say. — She promised a lot, but actions louder than words.

28. Add fuel to the fire — To make a bad situation worse. — Stop arguing; you're only adding fuel to the fire.

29. Beat around the bush — To avoid talking about the main subject. — Please don't beat around the bush; tell me the truth.

30. Better late than never — It is good to do something even if it is done late. — You apologized, better late than never.

31. Beyond the shadow of a doubt — Completely certain; no doubt about it. — He is beyond the shadow of a doubt the best player.

32. Bite the bullet — To face a painful or difficult situation bravely. — I had to bite the bullet and tell him the truth.

33. Break new ground — To do something that has not been done before. — This research breaks new ground in medicine.

34. Burn bridges — To destroy relationships so there is no way back. — Don't bum bridges; you may need those people later.

35. Call a spade a spade — To speak the truth clearly. — Let's call a spade a spade; he made a mistake.

36. Close but no cigar — To come very near to achieving something, but fail. - We played well, but close, yet no cigar.

37. Cost an arm and a leg — To be very expensive. — That laptop costs an arm and a leg!

38. Don't cry over spilt milk — Don't worry about things that have already happened. — It's over now, so don't cry over spilt milk.

39. Don’t put the cart before the horse — Don’t do things in the wrong order. — We need a plan first; don’t put the cart before the horse.

40. Don’t sweat the small stuff — Don’t worry about unimportant things. — Relax! Don’t sweat the small stuff.

41. Every dog has its day — Everyone will experience success sometime. — He is not famous now, but every dog has its day.

42. Get back on your feet — To recover from a difficult situation. — After losing his job, he worked hard to get back on his feet.

43. Give it a shot — To try something. — I’ve never done it before, but I'll give it a shot.

44. Go down the drain — To be wasted or ruined. — All our hard work went down the drain because of that mistake.

45. Great minds think alike — Intelligent people have similar ideas. — It’s a surprise we came up with the same plan; great minds think alike!

46. Have a bone to pick — To have a complaint about something. — I have a bone to pick with you about yesterday.

47. Hit the books — To study hard. — I need to hit the books for my final exams.

48. Hold your horses — To wait patiently. — Hold your horses; your tum will come.

49. Keep something up your sleeve — To have a secret plan. — He’s acting normal, but I think he has something up his sleeve.

50. Kill time — To spend time when you are bored or waiting. — I was early, so I just

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 19 (451-475)

51. Know like the back of your hand — To know something very well. — 1 know this city like the back of my hand.

52. Leave no stone unturned — To try everything possible. — We left no stone unturned to find the missing document.

53. Let bygones be bygones — To forgive and forget the past. — It’s time to let bygones be bygones and move on.

54. Let the chips fall where they may — To accept the results without trying to control them. — I’ve done my best; now let the chips fall where they may.

55. Like father, like son — Children behave the same way as their parents. — He is so kind, like father, like son.

56. Make a mountain out of a molehill — To exaggerate a small problem. — Don’t make a mountain out of a molehill; it’s just a tiny mistake.

57. Money talks — Wealthy people have more influence. — In politics, money talks.

58. More than meets the eye — There is more to something than you can see. — He looks shy, but there’s more than meets the eye.

59. On cloud nine — Extremely happy. — She was on cloud nine after getting the job.

60. Once in a while — Not often, but sometimes. - We meet once in a while for coffee.

61. Out of the blue — Suddenly and unexpectedly. — He called me out of the blue.

62. Pull yourself together — To calm down and behave properly. — You're upset; pull yourself together.

63. See the bigger picture — To think about the overall situation, not just details. — Don’t worry about the small errors; see the bigger picture.

64. Strike while the iron is hot — To act while the opportunity is good. — It’s the right time to invest; strike while the iron is hot.

65. Sweeten the deal — To make an offer more attractive. — They offered a bonus to sweeten the deal.

56. The ball is in your court — It’s your tum to act or decide. — I’ve explained everything; now the ball is in your court.

57. The heart wants what it wants — People desire what they want, not what is practical. — She left a good job because the heart wants what it wants.

58. There is no time like the present — The best time to do something is now. — If you want to start, remember there is no time like the present.

59. To be honest — To tell the truth. — To be honest, I didn’t like the movie.

'0. Too many cooks spoil the broth — When too many people are involved, things go wrong. — Let’s decide soon; too many cooks spoil the broth.

'1. ‘Turn over a new leaf — To start a new and better life. - After the new year, I want to tum over a new leaf.

'2. Under the weather — Not feeling well. — I can’t come out today; I’m feeling under the weather.

'3. When push comes to shove — In a difficult situation that requires a decision or action. — When push comes to shove, I will always choose honesty.

'4. You can’t have your cake and eat it too — You cannot have two good things that are impossible at the same time. — You can’t have your cake and eat it too; you must choose.

'5. You win some, you lose some — Sometimes you succeed, sometimes you fail. — We tied our best; you win some, you lose some.

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WITH MEANING & EXAMPLES

Page 20 (476-500)

'6. A burden off one's shoulders — To feel less worried or relieved. — I felt a burden off my shoulders after finishing the exam.

'7. Bite off more than you can chew — To take on more than you can handle. — Don't bite off more than you can chew; start small.

'8. Break a leg — Used to wish someone good luck. — You have your performance tonight? Break a leg!

'9. Call it a day — To stop working on something. — It's late, let's call it a day.

30. Cut to the chase — To get to the point. — Stop talking and cut to the chase.

31. Don't burn your bridges — Don't destroy a relationship that may be useful later. — Leave on good terms; don't bum your bridges.

32. Every little bit helps — Small efforts can make a big difference. — Saving water every day; every little bit helps.

33. Face the music — To accept the consequences of your actions. — You made a mistake, so face the music.

34. Go the extra mile — To do more than what is expected. — She always goes the extra mile for her students.

35. Hit below the belt — To say or do something unfair or unkind. — That comment was uncalled for; it hit below the belt.

36. In hot water — In trouble. — He is in hot water for breaking the rules.

37. Kill two birds with one stone — To do two things at the same time. — I did my homework while listening to the lecture; I killed two birds with one stone.

38. Let sleeping dogs lie — To avoid a problem by not bringing it up. — It's better to let sleeping dogs lie.

39. No pain, no gain — You must work hard to succeed. — Remember, no pain, no gain!

40. On the ball — To be efficient and quick. — Our teacher is always on the ball.

41. Piece of cake — Very easy. — The test was a piece of cake.

)2. Put all your eggs in one basket — To risk everything on a single plan or idea. — Don’t put all your eggs in one basket.

)3. Raise the bar — To set higher standards. - We must raise the bar to compete globally.

)4. See eye to eye — To agree with someone. — We don’t always see eye to eye, but we respect each other.

)5. Spill the beans — To tell a secret. — Don’t spill the beans about the surprise party!

)6. Take with a grain of salt — To not believe something completely. — Take his words with a grain of salt.

)7. The ball is in your court — It’s your tum to act. — I’ve explained my part; the ball is in your court now.

)8. Under the same roof — Living or working in the same place. — We grew up under the same roof. 499. When in doubt, do nothing — When unsure, it’s better to wait. — When in doubt, do nothing and think again. 500. You can’t judge a book by its cover — Don’t judge someone by appearance. — He looks shy, but you can’t judge a book by its cover. —— @omiistudies ——